14.2.2 Components of Computerised Accounting System

Components of CAS can be classified into six categories, namely, i) Hardware ii) Software iii) People iv) Procedure v) Data and vi) Connectivity.

i) Hardware: The physical components of a computer constitute its hardware. Hardware consists of input devices and output devices that make a complete computer system. Examples of input devices are keyboard, optical scanner, mouse, joystick, touch screen and slylus which are used to feed data into the computer. Output devices such as monitor and printer are media to get the output from the computer.

ii) Software: A set of programs that form an interface between the hardware and the user of a computer system are referred to as software. The following are the various types of software:

a) System software: A set of programs to control the internal operations such as reading data from input devices, giving results to output devices and ensuring proper functioning of components is called system software. The system software includes the following:
   (1) Operating system: A set of tools and programs to manage the overall working of a computer using a defined set of hardware components is called an operating system. It is the interface between the user and the computer system. Example: DOS, Windows, UBUNTU, imac, etc.
   (2) Programming software: Special software to accept data and interpret them in the form of machine/assembly language understandable by a computer. Example: C, PASCAL, COBOL, etc.
   (3) Utility software: These are designed specifically for managing the computer device and its resources. Example: File manager, Anti-virus software, etc.

b) Application software: Programs designed to perform a specific function for a user. An application software can be classified as follows:
   (i) General purpose software: This type of application can be used for a variety of tasks and not limited to one particular function. Example: MS-Office.
   (ii) Specific purpose software: This software is created to execute one specific task and they are customised to the needs of user. Example: Accounting software, payroll software, etc.]



Finacle is a banking software.

iii) People: The most important element of a computer system is its users. They are also called live-ware of the computer system. The following types of people interact with a computer system.

a) System analysts: People who design the operation and processing of the system.
b) System programmers: People who write codes and programs to implement the working of the system.

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